



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*dvayoh kṣetrajñayor madhye jīvātmā kṣetra-dharma-bhāk |
badhyate mucyate jñānād ity adhyāyārtha īritah ||
iti sārārtha-varṣiṇyām harṣiṇyām bhakta-cetasām |
trayodaśo 'yaṁ gītāsu saṅgataḥ saṅgataḥ satām ||
jīveṣau deha-madhyasthau tatrādyo deha-dharma-yuk |
badhyate mucyate bodhād iti jñānaṁ trayodaśāt ||*

— Bhagavadgītā-4comm with the commentaries of Śrīdhara, Madhusūdana, Viśvanātha and Baladeva, Chapter 1, Verse

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GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Within the tapestry of existence, woven with threads of the material world and the eternal spirit, lies the essence of your being. This verse from the Bhagavad Gītā, specifically from the thirteenth chapter, distills a profound truth: within you reside two knowers of the field (kṣetra), the individual soul (jīvātmā) and the Supreme Soul (Īśvara). The individual soul, entangled with the qualities (dharma) of the field of activity, which is the body, becomes bound. Liberation, however, arises from knowledge (jñāna).

Think of your body as a garden, a field where experiences blossom and wither. The individual soul, the jīvātmā, identifies so strongly with this garden, its joys and sorrows, its successes and failures, that it forgets its true nature, its connection to the gardener, the Supreme Soul. This identification leads to bondage, the cycle of birth and death, driven by desires and attachments.

The verse emphasizes that liberation from this cycle isn't achieved through physical feats or worldly accomplishments, but through knowledge. This isn't merely intellectual understanding, but a deep realization of the distinction between the self and the non-self, between the eternal and the temporary. It's recognizing that you are not the body, not the mind, not the emotions, but a spark of the Divine, temporarily residing within this physical form.

In modern life, bombarded by distractions and societal pressures, it's easy to lose sight of this truth. We chase fleeting pleasures, define ourselves by our possessions, and become slaves to our anxieties. The Bhagavad Gītā offers a powerful antidote: cultivate self-awareness. Through introspection, meditation, and mindful living, you can gradually disentangle yourself from the illusions of the material world and reconnect with your true self, the eternal soul. This journey of self-discovery, guided by wisdom and devotion, leads to liberation from suffering and the realization of your inherent divinity. By understanding the two knowers of the field and the path to liberation, you can navigate the complexities of life with greater clarity and purpose.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you identifying more with the garden (your body and mind) or the gardener (your true self), and how can you shift your focus towards the latter today?